

March

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2014

12 Years a Slave

The acclaimed film *12 Years a Slave* was the first movie with a Black director to win the Oscar for Best Picture. British filmmaker Steve McQueen (left) adapted the 1853 memoirs of Solomon Northup, which described his experiences as an enslaved Black man.

Born this day

1904 Theodor Seuss Geisel, US writer and illustrator. Using the pseudonym Dr Seuss, he wrote popular children's stories, including *The Cat in the Hat*.

2018

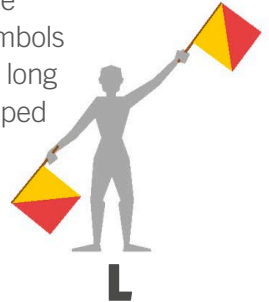
Penguin population

The discovery of a huge penguin colony in the Danger Islands, off the coast of western Antarctica, was announced. About 1.5 million Adélie penguins had been hiding in plain sight and were only found thanks to satellite images and a survey on the ground.

1791

Semaphore system

French inventor Claude Chappe invented a system of visual symbols that could be understood over long distances. He used towers topped with moving mechanical arms to send the first messages but hand-held flags have also been used.



Also on this day

1657 The Great Fire of Meireki raged through the city of Edo, killing thousands and destroying more than half of the Japanese capital.

1955 Black teenager Claudette Colvin refused to give up her seat to a white woman on a segregated bus in the USA, months before Rosa Parks famously protested in the same way.

1972 NASA's space probe Pioneer 10 was launched with a metal plaque on board that gave information about Earth's location.

